

Legacy Built, Future Driven: How Brandon Sawalich Is Redefining What a Hearing Aid Can Do



There are companies that follow the future. And then there is Starkey - a company that builds it. At the helm of this relentless pursuit stands Brandon Sawalich, President and CEO of Starkey, a leader who has spent his life's work ensuring that hearing loss never robs anyone of the moments that matter most. Inheriting a legacy of bold innovation and driving it further than anyone thought possible, Sawalich has transformed Starkey into the hearing industry's most formidable force - a company that does not wait for the future to arrive, but engineers it, deliberately and ahead of schedule. Now, with the arrival of Omega AI, the most advanced hearing technology ever created, he is doing it again - and this time, the leap is nothing short of superhuman.

Omega AI is not an upgrade. It is a reinvention. At its core is DNN 360, the world's first deep neural network-powered directionality system - an intelligence so sophisticated it does not merely respond to sound, it anticipates it, predicting the next acoustic adaptation before the user even registers the need. The result is up to 28% better speech intelligibility in the noisiest, most demanding environments, and an 8 dB signal-to-noise ratio improvement that delivers spatial awareness once thought exclusive to those with perfect hearing. "When excellence drives every process - innovation, quality, service, and delivery

- great things happen," says Sawalich. With Omega AI, they have.

The hardware is as formidable as the intelligence within it. All-new waterproof coating shown to be ten times more durable than previous technology, built with a shell resin 20 times stronger than before, and delivering an industry-leading 51 hours of battery life, Omega AI is engineered for real life at its most demanding. A world-first LED find-my-hearing-aid feature reflects the depth of thought Starkey brings to every detail - technology that does not just perform, but genuinely understands the people wearing it.

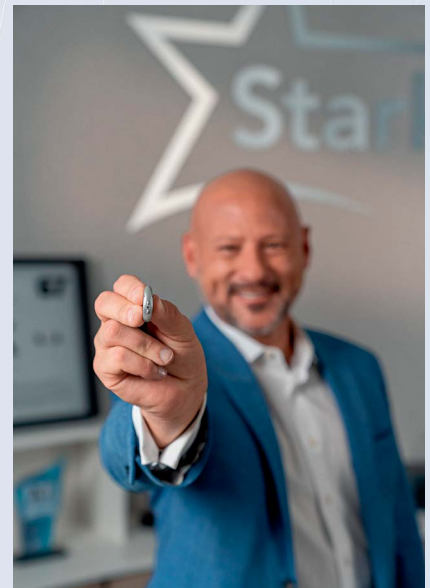
Connectivity is seamless and future-proof. The industry-first TeleHear AI feature uses generative AI to resolve common hearing challenges in real time, with a remarkable 93% predictive accuracy. Through the My Starkey app, firmware updates arrive instantly, ensuring every device evolves with its user - no clinic visit required. Omega AI does not simply keep pace with life. It stays one step ahead of it.

For Sawalich, however, hearing has always been only the beginning. Omega AI's Healthable features represent the most ambitious expression yet of Starkey's belief that the ear is the new wrist. Balance Builder delivers guided stability exercises to reduce fall risk. An industry-first automatic respiratory rate monitor tracks breathing silently

throughout the day. Fall detection with instant family alerts - pioneered by Starkey and still unmatched - continues to offer users and loved ones alike something beyond technology: genuine peace of mind.

India stands at the centre of this story. With one of the most technology-forward consumer cultures in the world and a rapidly growing Starkey team driving app development and future innovation, India is not simply a market - it is a creative partner in what comes next. And with new, more accessible product options on the horizon for Indian consumers, Starkey's commitment here is both commercial and deeply human.

"We are legacy built, future driven," Sawalich says. For the millions across India and beyond who deserve to hear life at its fullest - that future has arrived. Omega AI is now launched in India and is available at authorised dispenser clinics.



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